EMRTS Transfers during the COVID-19 Pandemic.

The criteria for EMRTS transfer has not changed. EMRTS will transfer patients who:

1. Require Level 2 or 3 critical care.
2. Have Life or Limb threatening injury or illness.
3. Are time-critical and require intervention that can only be carried out at the receiving hospital or have a high risk of deterioration unless they receive care that is best carried out at the receiving hospital.
4. Have been accepted by the receiving hospital.

EMRTS are not currently doing routine capacity transfers. These will be considered on a case-by-case basis if the hospital is under extreme pressure and there is no local staff available to transfer.

Call the Air Support Desk for all transfer requests as normal on **0300 1233201**. Referral should be from the ED or ICU consultant involved with the case. EMRTS Operating hours are 08:00 to 20:00.

However there will be limited flying of patients because of restrictions imposed by Babcock due to COVID. Individual risk assessments should be made on benefits of flying vs risks.

Patients can only be transferred by air if:

A. They have a negative SARS-CoV2 test (very unlikely in a time critical patient).

OR

B. They meet all of the following criteria:
    1. They are a **trauma** patient who is conscious and can give a history.
    2. They do not have a clinical history suggesting risk of COVID:
        - ✓ no history of fever,
        - ✓ no symptoms (Respiratory, Malaise, Fatigue, Diarrhoea)
        - ✓ no-one in same household who has had fever or symptoms in last 14 days
    3. The patient's temperature is <37.8C
    4. Red level PPE (including FFP3 mask) is not being used.
    5. The pilot agrees to fly the patient.

This will need to be discussed at the time of referral. If they do not meet the above criteria EMRTS can still assist with transfer (by road with WAST). This will obviously have implications for transfer times.

Long transfer times may result in very late finishes for the crew with risk of fatigue and potential for loss of service on the next day, therefore please call as early as possible if you think a patient will need a transfer. The crew have the right to decline a transfer if it will take them significantly beyond their working hours.